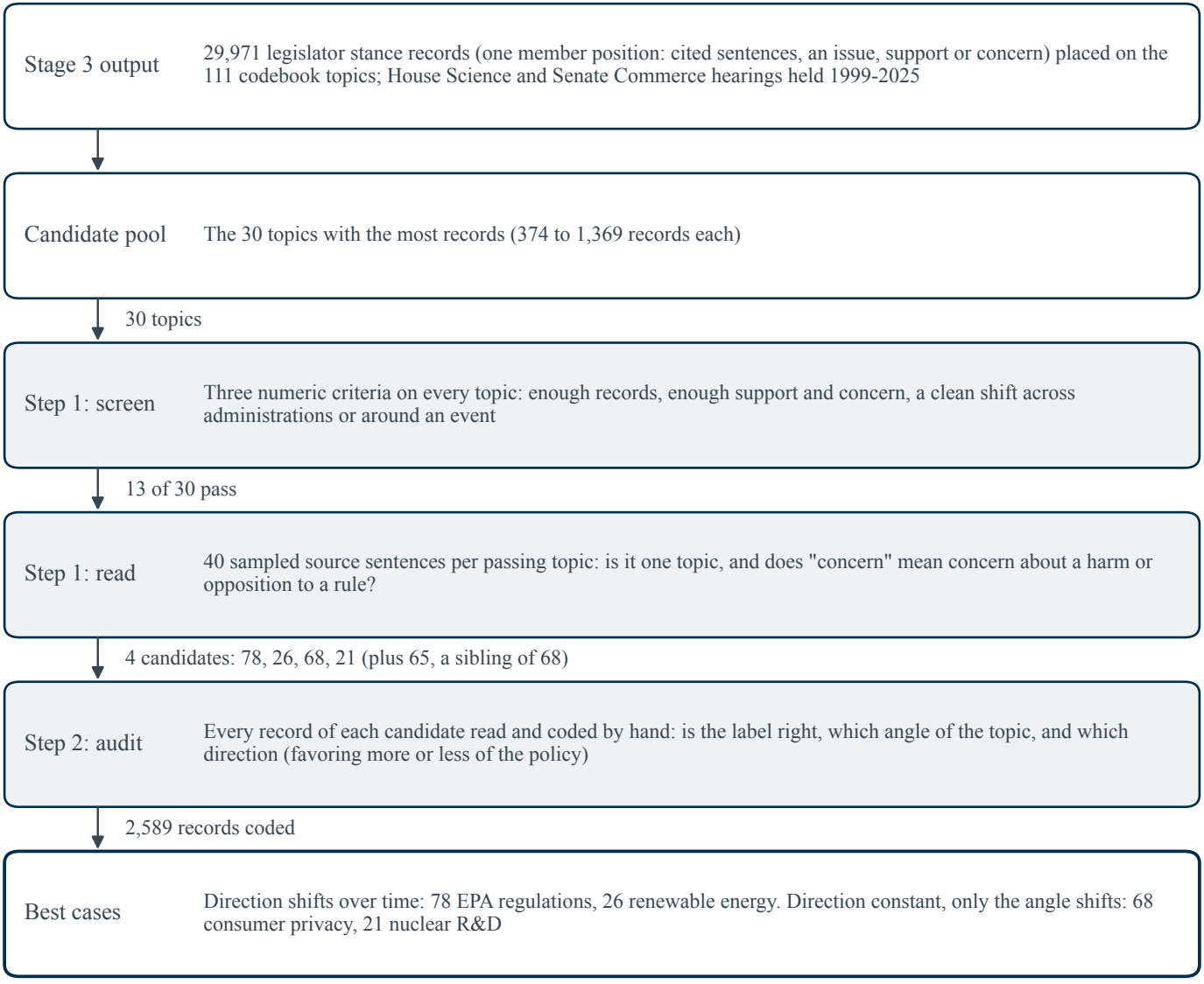
Stage 3 output
29,971 legislator stance records (one member position: cited sentences, an issue, support or concern) placed on the 111 codebook topics; House Science and Senate Commerce hearings held 1999-2025
Candidate pool
The 30 topics with the most records (374 to 1,369 records each)
30 topics
Step 1: screen
Three numeric criteria on every topic: enough records, enough support and concern, a clean shift across administrations or around an event
13 of 30 pass
Step 1: read
40 sampled source sentences per passing topic: is it one topic, and does "concern" mean concern about a harm or opposition to a rule?
4 candidates: 78, 26, 68, 21 (plus 65, a sibling of 68)
Step 2: audit
Every record of each candidate read and coded by hand: is the label right, which angle of the topic, and which direction (favoring more or less of the policy)
2,589 records coded
Best cases
Direction shifts over time: 78 EPA regulations, 26 renewable energy. Direction constant, only the angle shifts: 68 consumer privacy, 21 nuclear R&D